Skill 14

Recognize Cognitive Biases

What Bias Is Showing?

160 Items	**1-5** Levels	**Name the thinking bias shown in a choice.** Objective

Essential question. What mental pull is shaping this judgment?

This PDF is designed for classroom use. It gives teachers a rigorous introduction to the skill, a repeatable solving routine, likely student confusions, a worked example, and the full XiXteen item set with choice-level feedback.

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Skill 14

Recognize Cognitive Biases

What Bias Is Showing?

Name the thinking bias shown in a choice. Objective	**160** Items	**Levels 1-5** Difficulty bands

Essential question	What mental pull is shaping this judgment?
Why it matters	Biases are not just mistakes in arguments; they are patterns in attention, memory, confidence, and desire that shape judgment before an argument is even spoken.
Conceptual core	Cognitive biases are patterns in attention, memory, confidence, motivation, and social influence. Students should learn that bias does not mean stupidity or bad character; it means a normal mental shortcut is distorting judgment. The skill is to identify the pull: toward confirming what we already believe, following the group, protecting past effort, anchoring on the first number, or trusting what is easiest to recall.
Student method	Identify what is pulling the person's thinking off course: confirming a prior view, following the crowd, anchoring on a first number, protecting sunk costs, favoring the familiar, or overestimating certainty.
Analogy	A cognitive bias is like a lens tint. The scene is still there, but the tint changes what stands out and what fades.
Assessment focus	A good answer identifies the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking and distinguishes it from nearby labels.
Resource note	The quiz feedback links bias items to corresponding CogBias articles when a direct article match is available.

Teaching Sequence

1. Identify what the thinker is drawn toward or away from.

2. Separate evidence problems from mind-pattern problems.

3. Match the pattern to the bias label.

4. Suggest a debiasing move, such as seeking disconfirming evidence or resetting the anchor.

Common Confusions To Watch For

1. Students may label any mistake as bias without naming the mental pattern.

2. Students may confuse a fallacy in an argument with a bias in judgment.

3. Students may treat bias as something only other people have.

Teacher Prompts

1. What is pulling the person's attention?

2. What information is being overweighted or ignored?

3. What would a more balanced thinking move look like?

Worked Example

Scenario	After deciding a study app is helpful, a student reads only positive reviews and skips detailed negative reviews.
Teacher think-aloud	The student is filtering information to support a prior belief. That is confirmation bias, and the correction is to actively inspect evidence on the other side.
Student takeaway	Bias labels should point to a specific mental pull.

Guided Classroom Exercise

Invented case. Use only the facts below; write on paper. Try the steps and check your work before reading the model answer. Different wording can be equally adequate.

Situation. After buying a study app, Sam reads six glowing reviews and skips four detailed critical reviews because 'they will only make me doubt my choice'. Sam concludes the app must improve learning. No learning results have been collected.

What To Do

1. Identify the evidence Sam selects and the evidence Sam avoids, and explain the direction of the preference.

2. Write a three-step checking plan: include both kinds of reviews, use the same quality criteria for them, and collect a learning measure rather than relying only on praise.

3. Name a specific learning measure, such as a delayed quiz on comparable material, and say why review popularity alone is insufficient.

Check before reading the answer. Does your plan make it possible to discover that the purchase was unhelpful, or only reassure Sam?

Model Answer

Sam favours praise that confirms the purchase and avoids criticism that could challenge it. Plan: read all ten reviews; assess each for relevant experience and checkable evidence using the same criteria; compare delayed-quiz performance on comparable material studied with and without the app under similar conditions. Positive reviews show approval, not necessarily better learning.

Why it is adequate. It describes the selective attention and turns a vague request to 'be unbiased' into concrete checks capable of revealing a mistake.

Item Bank

Items are grouped by level. For each item, read the prompt, predict the answer, choose, and then use the feedback and process commentary to examine the reasoning path.

Level 1

Level 1 establishes the clean version of the skill: the cue is direct, the distractors are visible, and the main task is to learn the contrast.

cognitive_biases-001 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about evening bus service for late-shift workers, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to extend evening bus service until midnight and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning choice	**B.** Sunk cost bias choice
C. Confirmation bias correct	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, transportation, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-002 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about classroom phone lockers, Maya hears one vivid story about ninth-grade students and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Availability bias correct	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, education, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-003 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about medication reminder texts for older patients, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Anchoring correct

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, health, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-004 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about a four-day workweek test for software engineers, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Sunk cost bias correct	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, workplace, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-005 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about larger grocery unit-price labels, Taylor predicts exact results from adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias correct
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, retail, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-006 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about late fines on children's books, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias correct	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, public services, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-007 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about two-factor login for site administrators, Casey praises weak evidence supporting requiring two-factor login for site administrators because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning correct

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, technology, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-008 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about brighter streetlights on Maple Street, Jordan supports adding brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Bandwagon effect correct	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, public safety, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-009 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about peer tutoring for first-year statistics students, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to expand peer tutoring in statistics and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Confirmation bias correct
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, education, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-010 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about calorie labels on restaurant menus, Maya hears one vivid story about lunch customers and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Availability bias correct	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, nutrition, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-011 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about bank overdraft warning texts, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Anchoring correct	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, finance, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-012 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about timed-entry passes for weekend park trails, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning choice	**B.** Confirmation bias choice
C. Sunk cost bias correct	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, environment, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-013 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about free Friday museum admission, Taylor predicts exact results from offering free admission on Fridays even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Overconfidence bias correct	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, culture, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-014 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about youth soccer concussion checks, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Status quo bias correct

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, sports, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-015 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about same-day donation receipts, Casey praises weak evidence supporting sending donation receipts within one day because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Motivated reasoning correct	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, nonprofit, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-016 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about warehouse ergonomic training, Jordan supports offering monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Confirmation bias choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect correct

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, workplace safety, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-017 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about apartment-lobby compost bins, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to place compost bins in apartment lobbies and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias correct	**B.** Sunk cost bias choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, environment, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-018 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about private-by-default app profiles, Maya hears one vivid story about new app users and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Availability bias correct
C. Confirmation bias choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, technology, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-019 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about same-day clinic appointment slots, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Anchoring correct	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, health, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-020 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about seat-zone airline boarding, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias correct	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, travel, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-021 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about an online apartment repair portal, Taylor predicts exact results from launching an online apartment repair portal even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias correct
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, housing, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-022 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about fruit placement in a school cafeteria line, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Confirmation bias choice	**D.** Status quo bias correct

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, food, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-023 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about weekly call-center script coaching, Casey praises weak evidence supporting giving support agents weekly script coaching because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning correct
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, customer support, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-024 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about household water-leak alerts, Jordan supports sending automatic household water-leak alerts after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect correct	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, utilities, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-025 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about body-camera activation reminders, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to send body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Confirmation bias correct

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, governance, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

cognitive_biases-026 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about county mail-ballot tracking, Maya hears one vivid story about mail voters and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Availability bias correct	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, election administration, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-027 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about language-learning spaced-review prompts, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Anchoring correct	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, learning, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-028 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about a beginner gym orientation, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Sunk cost bias correct
C. Confirmation bias choice	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, fitness, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-029 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about safe-driving feedback for policyholders, Taylor predicts exact results from sending weekly safe-driving feedback even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias correct

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, insurance, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-030 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about top-of-article correction boxes, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Status quo bias correct
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, media, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-031 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about clearer farmers market price signs, Casey praises weak evidence supporting requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning correct

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, local commerce, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-032 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about hotel quiet-hours text reminders, Jordan supports sending quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect correct
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, hospitality, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Level 2

Level 2 keeps the same skill but adds more realistic wording and more tempting distractors.

cognitive_biases-033 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about evening bus service for late-shift workers, Maya hears one vivid story about late-shift workers and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Availability bias correct	**B.** Sunk cost bias choice
C. Status quo bias choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, transportation, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-034 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about classroom phone lockers, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Anchoring correct
C. Motivated reasoning choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, education, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-035 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about medication reminder texts for older patients, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Sunk cost bias correct	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, health, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-036 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about a four-day workweek test for software engineers, Taylor predicts exact results from testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias correct

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, workplace, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-037 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about larger grocery unit-price labels, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias correct	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, retail, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-038 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about late fines on children's books, Casey praises weak evidence supporting waiving late fines for children's books because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning correct
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, public services, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-039 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about two-factor login for site administrators, Jordan supports requiring two-factor login for site administrators after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Confirmation bias choice
C. Bandwagon effect correct	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, technology, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-040 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about brighter streetlights on Maple Street, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to add brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Confirmation bias correct

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, public safety, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

cognitive_biases-041 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about peer tutoring for first-year statistics students, Maya hears one vivid story about first-year statistics students and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Availability bias correct	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, education, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-042 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about calorie labels on restaurant menus, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Motivated reasoning choice	**D.** Anchoring correct

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, nutrition, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-043 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about bank overdraft warning texts, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Sunk cost bias correct
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, finance, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-044 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about timed-entry passes for weekend park trails, Taylor predicts exact results from using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias correct	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, environment, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-045 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about free Friday museum admission, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Confirmation bias choice	**D.** Status quo bias correct

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, culture, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-046 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about youth soccer concussion checks, Casey praises weak evidence supporting adding mandatory sideline concussion checks because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Motivated reasoning correct	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, sports, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-047 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about same-day donation receipts, Jordan supports sending donation receipts within one day after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect correct
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, nonprofit, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-048 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about warehouse ergonomic training, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to offer monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias correct	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Status quo bias choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, workplace safety, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-049 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about apartment-lobby compost bins, Maya hears one vivid story about apartment residents and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Confirmation bias choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Availability bias correct

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, environment, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-050 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about private-by-default app profiles, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Anchoring correct	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, technology, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-051 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about same-day clinic appointment slots, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Sunk cost bias correct
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, health, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-052 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about seat-zone airline boarding, Taylor predicts exact results from boarding passengers by seat zone even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias correct	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, travel, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-053 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about an online apartment repair portal, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Status quo bias correct	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, housing, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-054 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about fruit placement in a school cafeteria line, Casey praises weak evidence supporting moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Confirmation bias choice
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning correct

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, food, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-055 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about weekly call-center script coaching, Jordan supports giving support agents weekly script coaching after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect correct	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, customer support, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-056 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about household water-leak alerts, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to send automatic household water-leak alerts and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning choice	**B.** Confirmation bias correct
C. Status quo bias choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, utilities, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-057 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about body-camera activation reminders, Maya hears one vivid story about patrol officers and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Availability bias correct	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, governance, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-058 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about county mail-ballot tracking, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Anchoring correct

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, election administration, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-059 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about language-learning spaced-review prompts, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias correct	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, learning, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-060 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about a beginner gym orientation, Taylor predicts exact results from offering a beginner gym orientation even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias correct
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Confirmation bias choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, fitness, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

cognitive_biases-061 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about safe-driving feedback for policyholders, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias correct	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Confirmation bias choice	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, insurance, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-062 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about top-of-article correction boxes, Casey praises weak evidence supporting placing corrections at the top of articles because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning correct
C. Status quo bias choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, media, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-063 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about clearer farmers market price signs, Jordan supports requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect correct

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, local commerce, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-064 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about hotel quiet-hours text reminders, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to send quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Confirmation bias correct	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, hospitality, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

Level 3

Level 3 asks for steadier discrimination: the right answer is still objective, but the wrong answers often sound plausible.

cognitive_biases-065 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about evening bus service for late-shift workers, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Anchoring correct

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, transportation, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-066 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about classroom phone lockers, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Sunk cost bias correct	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, education, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-067 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about medication reminder texts for older patients, Taylor predicts exact results from sending medication reminder texts before evening doses even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias correct
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, health, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-068 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about a four-day workweek test for software engineers, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias correct	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Confirmation bias choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, workplace, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-069 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about larger grocery unit-price labels, Casey praises weak evidence supporting adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning correct

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, retail, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-070 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about late fines on children's books, Jordan supports waiving late fines for children's books after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Bandwagon effect correct	**D.** Confirmation bias choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, public services, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

cognitive_biases-071 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about two-factor login for site administrators, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to require two-factor login for site administrators and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Confirmation bias correct
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, technology, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-072 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about brighter streetlights on Maple Street, Maya hears one vivid story about residents on Maple Street and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Availability bias correct	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, public safety, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-073 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about peer tutoring for first-year statistics students, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Anchoring correct

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, education, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-074 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about calorie labels on restaurant menus, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Confirmation bias choice
C. Sunk cost bias correct	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, nutrition, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-075 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about bank overdraft warning texts, Taylor predicts exact results from sending overdraft warning texts before fees post even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias correct	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, finance, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-076 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about timed-entry passes for weekend park trails, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Status quo bias correct
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, environment, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-077 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about free Friday museum admission, Casey praises weak evidence supporting offering free admission on Fridays because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Motivated reasoning correct	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, culture, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-078 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about youth soccer concussion checks, Jordan supports adding mandatory sideline concussion checks after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect correct

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, sports, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-079 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about same-day donation receipts, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to send donation receipts within one day and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias correct	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, nonprofit, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-080 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about warehouse ergonomic training, Maya hears one vivid story about warehouse staff and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Availability bias correct
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, workplace safety, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-081 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about apartment-lobby compost bins, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Anchoring correct	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, environment, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-082 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about private-by-default app profiles, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Motivated reasoning choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias correct

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, technology, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-083 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about same-day clinic appointment slots, Taylor predicts exact results from reserving same-day appointment slots even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Overconfidence bias correct	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, health, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-084 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about seat-zone airline boarding, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Status quo bias correct

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, travel, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-085 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about an online apartment repair portal, Casey praises weak evidence supporting launching an online apartment repair portal because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning correct
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Confirmation bias choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, housing, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

cognitive_biases-086 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about fruit placement in a school cafeteria line, Jordan supports moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect correct	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, food, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-087 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about weekly call-center script coaching, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to give support agents weekly script coaching and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Motivated reasoning choice	**D.** Confirmation bias correct

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, customer support, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

cognitive_biases-088 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about household water-leak alerts, Maya hears one vivid story about local homeowners and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Confirmation bias choice
C. Availability bias correct	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, utilities, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-089 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about body-camera activation reminders, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Anchoring correct
C. Confirmation bias choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, governance, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-090 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about county mail-ballot tracking, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias correct	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, election administration, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-091 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about language-learning spaced-review prompts, Taylor predicts exact results from sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Sunk cost bias choice
C. Confirmation bias choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias correct

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, learning, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-092 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about a beginner gym orientation, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Status quo bias correct	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, fitness, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-093 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about safe-driving feedback for policyholders, Casey praises weak evidence supporting sending weekly safe-driving feedback because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning correct
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Confirmation bias choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, insurance, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

cognitive_biases-094 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about top-of-article correction boxes, Jordan supports placing corrections at the top of articles after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect correct	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, media, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-095 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about clearer farmers market price signs, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to require clearer price signs at vendor stalls and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias correct	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, local commerce, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-096 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about hotel quiet-hours text reminders, Maya hears one vivid story about overnight hotel guests and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Availability bias correct
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, hospitality, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

Level 4

Level 4 asks learners to hold more context in mind while applying the same method.

cognitive_biases-097 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about evening bus service for late-shift workers, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias correct	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, transportation, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-098 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about classroom phone lockers, Taylor predicts exact results from requiring phone lockers during class even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias correct
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, education, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-099 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about medication reminder texts for older patients, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Status quo bias correct	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, health, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-100 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about a four-day workweek test for software engineers, Casey praises weak evidence supporting testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning correct

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, workplace, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-101 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about larger grocery unit-price labels, Jordan supports adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect correct	**B.** Sunk cost bias choice
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Confirmation bias choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, retail, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

cognitive_biases-102 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about late fines on children's books, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to waive late fines for children's books and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Confirmation bias correct
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, public services, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-103 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about two-factor login for site administrators, Maya hears one vivid story about site administrators and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Confirmation bias choice
C. Availability bias correct	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, technology, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-104 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about brighter streetlights on Maple Street, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Confirmation bias choice
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Anchoring correct

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, public safety, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-105 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about peer tutoring for first-year statistics students, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias correct	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, education, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-106 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about calorie labels on restaurant menus, Taylor predicts exact results from showing calorie labels on printed lunch menus even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias correct
C. Motivated reasoning choice	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, nutrition, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-107 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about bank overdraft warning texts, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Motivated reasoning choice	**D.** Status quo bias correct

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, finance, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-108 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about timed-entry passes for weekend park trails, Casey praises weak evidence supporting using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Motivated reasoning correct	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, environment, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-109 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about free Friday museum admission, Jordan supports offering free admission on Fridays after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect correct
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, culture, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-110 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about youth soccer concussion checks, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to add mandatory sideline concussion checks and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias correct	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, sports, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-111 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about same-day donation receipts, Maya hears one vivid story about first-time donors and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Confirmation bias choice	**D.** Availability bias correct

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, nonprofit, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-112 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about warehouse ergonomic training, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Anchoring correct	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, workplace safety, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-113 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about apartment-lobby compost bins, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Sunk cost bias correct
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, environment, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-114 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about private-by-default app profiles, Taylor predicts exact results from making new user profiles private by default even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias correct	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Motivated reasoning choice	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, technology, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-115 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about same-day clinic appointment slots, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Confirmation bias choice
C. Motivated reasoning choice	**D.** Status quo bias correct

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, health, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-116 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about seat-zone airline boarding, Casey praises weak evidence supporting boarding passengers by seat zone because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Motivated reasoning correct	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, travel, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-117 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about an online apartment repair portal, Jordan supports launching an online apartment repair portal after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Bandwagon effect correct	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, housing, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-118 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about fruit placement in a school cafeteria line, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to move fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Confirmation bias correct

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, food, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

cognitive_biases-119 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about weekly call-center script coaching, Maya hears one vivid story about support agents and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Availability bias correct	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Confirmation bias choice	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, customer support, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-120 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about household water-leak alerts, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning choice	**B.** Anchoring correct
C. Status quo bias choice	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, utilities, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-121 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about body-camera activation reminders, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Sunk cost bias correct	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, governance, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-122 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about county mail-ballot tracking, Taylor predicts exact results from offering online mail-ballot tracking even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Sunk cost bias choice
C. Motivated reasoning choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias correct

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, election administration, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-123 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about language-learning spaced-review prompts, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias correct	**B.** Confirmation bias choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Anchoring choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, learning, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

cognitive_biases-124 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about a beginner gym orientation, Casey praises weak evidence supporting offering a beginner gym orientation because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning correct
C. Status quo bias choice	**D.** Confirmation bias choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, fitness, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

cognitive_biases-125 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about safe-driving feedback for policyholders, Jordan supports sending weekly safe-driving feedback after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect correct	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Status quo bias choice	**D.** Confirmation bias choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, insurance, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

cognitive_biases-126 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about top-of-article correction boxes, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to place corrections at the top of articles and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Confirmation bias correct
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, media, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-127 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about clearer farmers market price signs, Maya hears one vivid story about weekend farmers market shoppers and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Confirmation bias choice	**D.** Availability bias correct

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, local commerce, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-128 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about hotel quiet-hours text reminders, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Anchoring correct	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, hospitality, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

Level 5

Level 5 is for fluency: the learner should now name the thinking move and explain the elimination path.

cognitive_biases-129 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about evening bus service for late-shift workers, Taylor predicts exact results from extending evening bus service until midnight even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias correct

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, transportation, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-130 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about classroom phone lockers, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Status quo bias correct	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, education, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-131 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about medication reminder texts for older patients, Casey praises weak evidence supporting sending medication reminder texts before evening doses because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning correct
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, health, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-132 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about a four-day workweek test for software engineers, Jordan supports testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect correct	**B.** Confirmation bias choice
C. Status quo bias choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, workplace, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-133 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about larger grocery unit-price labels, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to add larger unit-price labels on shelf tags and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Confirmation bias correct

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, retail, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

cognitive_biases-134 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about late fines on children's books, Maya hears one vivid story about families checking out children's books and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Sunk cost bias choice
C. Availability bias correct	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, public services, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-135 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about two-factor login for site administrators, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Anchoring correct
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, technology, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-136 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about brighter streetlights on Maple Street, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias correct	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Status quo bias choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, public safety, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-137 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about peer tutoring for first-year statistics students, Taylor predicts exact results from expanding peer tutoring in statistics even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias correct
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, education, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-138 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about calorie labels on restaurant menus, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Status quo bias correct	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Motivated reasoning choice	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, nutrition, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-139 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about bank overdraft warning texts, Casey praises weak evidence supporting sending overdraft warning texts before fees post because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Motivated reasoning correct	**D.** Status quo bias choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, finance, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

cognitive_biases-140 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about timed-entry passes for weekend park trails, Jordan supports using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect correct	**B.** Confirmation bias choice
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, environment, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-141 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about free Friday museum admission, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to offer free admission on Fridays and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias correct	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, culture, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-142 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about youth soccer concussion checks, Maya hears one vivid story about youth soccer players and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Availability bias correct
C. Sunk cost bias choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, sports, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-143 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about same-day donation receipts, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Anchoring correct	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Motivated reasoning choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, nonprofit, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-144 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about warehouse ergonomic training, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Availability bias choice	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Sunk cost bias correct	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, workplace safety, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-145 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about apartment-lobby compost bins, Taylor predicts exact results from placing compost bins in apartment lobbies even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias correct	**B.** Confirmation bias choice
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, environment, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-146 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about private-by-default app profiles, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect choice
C. Status quo bias correct	**D.** Motivated reasoning choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, technology, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-147 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about same-day clinic appointment slots, Casey praises weak evidence supporting reserving same-day appointment slots because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Confirmation bias choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Motivated reasoning correct	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, health, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-148 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about seat-zone airline boarding, Jordan supports boarding passengers by seat zone after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Status quo bias choice
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect correct

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, travel, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-149 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about an online apartment repair portal, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to launch an online apartment repair portal and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Confirmation bias correct

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, housing, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

cognitive_biases-150 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about fruit placement in a school cafeteria line, Maya hears one vivid story about middle-school students and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Availability bias correct	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, food, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-151 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about weekly call-center script coaching, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Anchoring correct
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, customer support, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-152 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. In a discussion about household water-leak alerts, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias correct	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Motivated reasoning choice	**D.** Bandwagon effect choice

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is A because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, utilities, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

cognitive_biases-153 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about body-camera activation reminders, Taylor predicts exact results from sending body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts even though no similar test has been run. Which thinking bias is shown in Taylor's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Anchoring choice
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Overconfidence bias correct

Core explanation. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Overconfidence bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, overconfidence, governance, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows overconfidence bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-154 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about county mail-ballot tracking, Morgan rejects the proposal mainly because the current system feels familiar. Which thinking bias is shown in Morgan's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning choice	**B.** Status quo bias correct
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. The current option is favored because it is already in place.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Status quo bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, status-quo, election administration, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The current option is favored because it is already in place. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows status quo bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-155 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about language-learning spaced-review prompts, Casey praises weak evidence supporting sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary because that conclusion would help Casey's preferred plan. Which thinking bias is shown in Casey's thinking?

A. Status quo bias choice	**B.** Overconfidence bias choice
C. Bandwagon effect choice	**D.** Motivated reasoning correct

Core explanation. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Motivated reasoning names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, motivated-reasoning, learning, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Status quo bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the current option is favored because it is already in place. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Status quo bias

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows motivated reasoning.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

D feedback (Correct): Correct. The evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

cognitive_biases-156 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about a beginner gym orientation, Jordan supports offering a beginner gym orientation after seeing that most classmates or coworkers support it, without checking the evidence. Which thinking bias is shown in Jordan's thinking?

A. Motivated reasoning choice	**B.** Bandwagon effect correct
C. Overconfidence bias choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias choice

Core explanation. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Bandwagon effect names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, bandwagon, fitness, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows bandwagon effect.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

cognitive_biases-157 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. In a discussion about safe-driving feedback for policyholders, Riley reads only comments praising the plan to send weekly safe-driving feedback and ignores equally detailed criticism. Which thinking bias is shown in Riley's thinking?

A. Bandwagon effect choice	**B.** Confirmation bias correct
C. Anchoring choice	**D.** Availability bias choice

Core explanation. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is B because Confirmation bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, confirmation-bias, insurance, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Bandwagon effect is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person follows the crowd rather than the reasons. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Bandwagon effect

B feedback (Correct): Correct. The person favors evidence that supports an existing view. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows confirmation bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-158 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about top-of-article correction boxes, Maya hears one vivid story about newsletter readers and assumes that example shows what usually happens. Which thinking bias is shown in Maya's thinking?

A. Overconfidence bias choice	**B.** Sunk cost bias choice
C. Confirmation bias choice	**D.** Availability bias correct

Core explanation. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Availability bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, availability-bias, media, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Confirmation bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person favors evidence that supports an existing view. This scenario shows availability bias.
Study link: CogBias - Confirmation bias

D feedback (Correct): Correct. A memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

cognitive_biases-159 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. In a discussion about clearer farmers market price signs, Sam sees a first cost guess of $900,000 for the plan. After that, Sam treats $850,000 as cheap without checking what the plan should cost. Which thinking bias is shown in Sam's thinking?

A. Sunk cost bias choice	**B.** Availability bias choice
C. Anchoring correct	**D.** Overconfidence bias choice

Core explanation. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is C because Anchoring names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, anchoring, local commerce, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Sunk cost bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

C feedback (Correct): Correct. Judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Overconfidence bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the person shows more certainty than the evidence supports. This scenario shows anchoring.
Study link: CogBias - Overconfidence effect

cognitive_biases-160 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. In a discussion about hotel quiet-hours text reminders, Avery's team keeps funding the plan because it already spent a year developing it, even after early results look poor. Which thinking bias is shown in Avery's thinking?

A. Anchoring choice	**B.** Motivated reasoning choice
C. Availability bias choice	**D.** Sunk cost bias correct

Core explanation. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, identify the mental pull in the scenario. The correct choice is D because Sunk cost bias names the bias pattern shown by the person's thinking.

Tags: cognitive_biases, bias, sunk-cost, hospitality, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Anchoring is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: judgment is pulled toward the first number encountered. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Anchoring effect

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Motivated reasoning is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: the evaluation is shaped by the desired conclusion. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Motivated reasoning

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Availability bias is a real bias, but it points to a different pattern: a memorable example is treated as more common than it may be. This scenario shows sunk cost bias.
Study link: CogBias - Availability heuristic

D feedback (Correct): Correct. Past unrecoverable costs are allowed to drive the current decision. The choice names the bias shown by the person's thinking.
Study link: CogBias - Sunk cost effect